The WordPress Speed Checklist

WordPress Speed Optimization 2026: A Small-Team Checklist

Site: Date:

MEASURE

- [ ] Record field data from PageSpeed Insights and Search Console (if available).
- [ ] Record lab LCP, TBT, CLS, TTFB and page weight for three representative pages.
- [ ] Note your host, PHP version, theme, caching setup, CDN and plugin count.

SERVER

- [ ] Run PHP 8.3 or newer (tested on staging first).
- [ ] Confirm the server location suits your audience.
- [ ] Check whether you are hitting plan resource limits.
- [ ] Use server-level page and object caching if your host offers it.

CACHING

- [ ] Use exactly one page cache.
- [ ] Exclude cart, checkout, account and logged-in pages.
- [ ] Confirm cached pages show a lower TTFB on repeat tests.
- [ ] Enable object caching for WooCommerce or membership sites where available.

NOTES

IMAGES

- [ ] Resize images to their display size before upload.
- [ ] Confirm WebP/AVIF support in Site Health and convert where useful.
- [ ] Bulk-compress the existing media library.
- [ ] Make sure the main above-the-fold image is not lazy-loaded.
- [ ] Set width and height on all images and embeds.

CODE

- [ ] Audit plugins with Query Monitor on staging.
- [ ] Remove unused and duplicate plugins.
- [ ] Reduce or defer non-essential third-party scripts.
- [ ] Load feature scripts only on pages that need them.

DELIVERY

- [ ] Put a CDN in front of static assets.
- [ ] Decide deliberately whether to cache HTML at the edge.
- [ ] Remove any reliance on Cloudflare Auto Minify.

STABILITY AND MONITORING

- [ ] Reserve space for ads, banners and embeds.
- [ ] Limit and self-host web fonts where practical.
- [ ] Check the Search Console Core Web Vitals report monthly.